

BBQS Consortium Governance Structure

Version History

Version	Date	Description of Change	Author
0.1	1/07/26	Draft	Jyl Boline
0.2	2/03/26	Small edits, edited image	Jyl Boline
0.3	3/4&3/9/26	Additional policies added	Jyl Boline
0.4	06/29/26	Data Access Committee updated, minor edits to image	Jyl Boline & Laura Cabrera
0.5	07/15/26	Addition of information to PI Committee, Data Access Committee updates	Jyl Boline & Laura Cabrera
0.6	07/16/26	Data Access Committee updates and it was moved to Future Committee section. Image updated.	Jyl Boline, Laura Cabrera & Satra Ghosh
1.0	07/17/26	Reviewed during PI meeting, updated based on suggestions and consensus, accepted by the PIs up through page 7 with the caveat that Defining BBQS Participation will be further defined in the future	PI Attendees of 07/16/26 meeting

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Version 1.0, July 16, 2026

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This document establishes the governance framework for the BBQS Consortium, defines the roles, responsibilities, and operational procedures for consortium leadership and decision-making processes.

Goals

The goals of this governance structure are to increase communication across the consortium, provide clear decision-making processes, and engage members through meaningful participation opportunities. The framework is meant to empower members and maintain accountability through defined expectations, and aid efficient operations.

ORGANIZATION

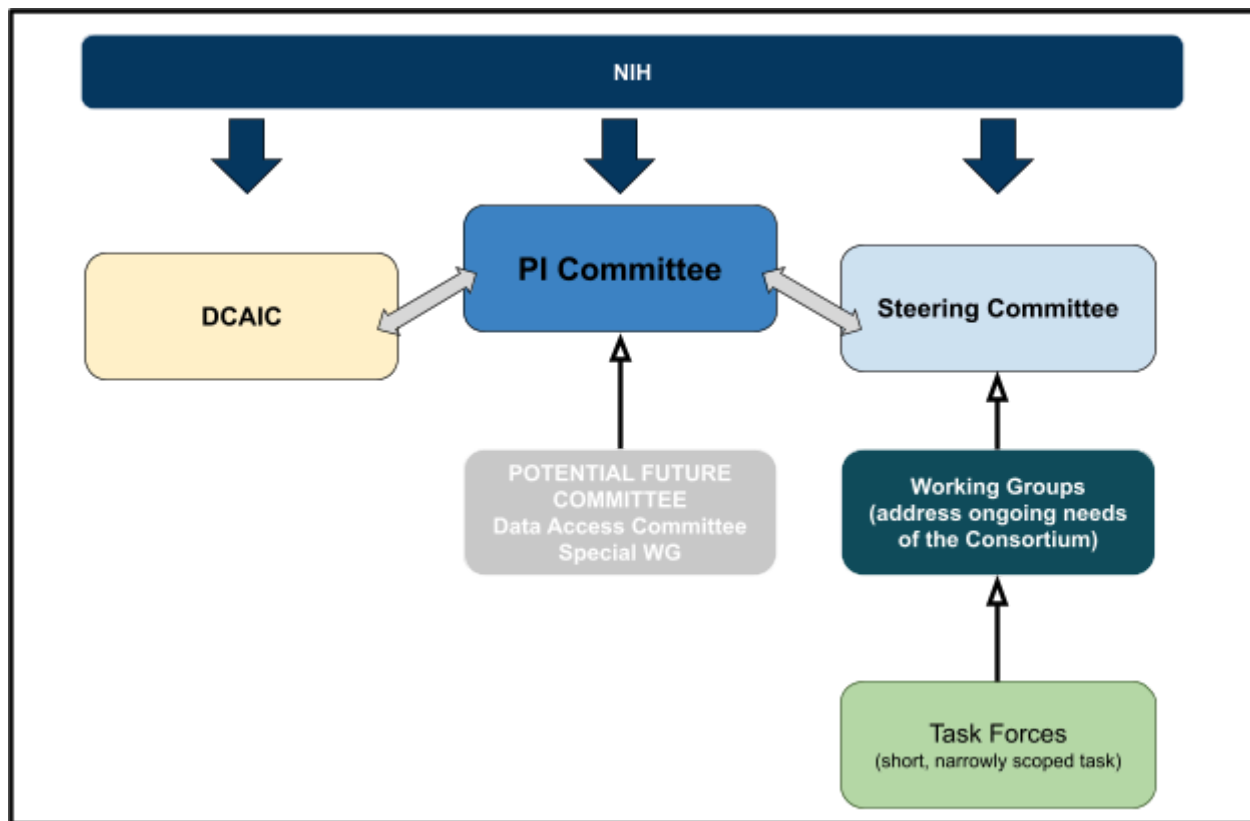


Diagram of overall organization reporting structure

NIH

Representatives from NIH will set overall goals and expectations of the BBQS Consortium.

PI Committee (PIC)

The PI Committee will be the primary decision-making body of the BBQS Consortium.

Composition:

- One voting PI representative from each BBQS project, although others may attend
- Contact PIs with more than one BBQS project will have [one vote for each research team](#).

- Exception: the grants focus on different things, each project will have a separate voting representative. Exceptions will be determined with the aid of NIH representatives
- PIs no longer funded by BBQS will not count towards Quorum but will be allowed a vote
- A Chair will be elected by committee members (2-year term limit)
- Vice-Chair will assume Chair responsibilities in Chair's absence
- DCAIC project manager (non-voting)

Voting Procedure:

1. A member makes a motion (usually to vote, postpone, or table the topic)
2. Another member seconds it
3. The chair calls the vote (yes, no, abstain) and abstains from voting except in a tie
4. The chair announces the result (motion accepted or rejected)
5. The motion, mover, and outcome is captured in the minutes

Responsibilities and Decision Making:

- Set the strategic direction for the BBQS Consortium
- Set and enforce consortium-wide policies and procedures
- Review/confirm major decisions by SC
- Quorum is 60% of voting members from actively funded BBQS projects
- Voting decisions will require a simple majority

Meeting Schedule:

- Quarterly
- Ad hoc meetings as needed for urgent matters
- Other updates or voting may take place over email

Steering Committee (SC)

The SC will further collaboration and integration efforts across BBQS.

Composition:

- Each BBQS project is encouraged to have at least one representative on the SC
- Additional members from the projects are encouraged to participate
- A Chair will be elected by committee members (2-year term limit, renewable once)
- Vice-Chair will assume Chair responsibilities in Chair's absence
- DCAIC project manager

Responsibilities and Decision Making:

- Oversight and tracking of consortium collaborative activities
- Propose formation & dissolution of Working Groups and review Working Group activities
- Contribute to vision and goals of BBQS-wide meetings
- [Quorum is 60%](#)
- Voting decisions will require a simple majority
- Major decisions will go to the PI Committee for final review and vote

Meeting Schedule:

- Monthly or bimonthly depending on need
 - Ad hoc meetings as needed for urgent matters
 - Other updates or voting may take place over email
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[Data Coordination and AI Center \(DCAIC\)](#)

Data Coordination and AI Center (DCAIC) serves as the technical resource of the BBQS Consortium and supports collaboration and integration efforts across BBQS.

Composition:

- DCAIC PIs and staff

Responsibilities:

- Serve as a hub for efficient data curation, management, and sharing
- Establish data standards for novel sensors and multimodal data integration
- Develop and define appropriate ML/AI resources for BBQS
- Create a cloud-based data ecosystem and computational platform
- Provide efficient dissemination, training, and coordination of BBQS research resources

Meeting Schedule:

- Monthly or more frequently depending on need
 - *Ad hoc* meetings as needed for urgent matters
 - Other updates may take place over email
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Working Group (WG)

- A group of BBQS participants (and invited guests as needed) to address ongoing needs of the consortium

- Each WG group will have its own Charter
 - Leadership for each WG will be determined by the WG as outlined in their Charter
 - A WG may be formed or dissolved as determined by the SC
 - At a minimum, progress towards WG goals will be reviewed on an annual basis by the SC
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Task Force (TF)

- A group of BBQS participants (and invited guests as needed) assembled for a narrowly scoped task for a short span of time
 - A TF may be formed or dissolved as determined by one of the WGs
 - TFs will report their findings/recommendations/and or proposal to the parent WG
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PI ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

To meet the overall goals of BBQS requires collaboration and cooperation to address challenging and complex issues together. As such, we propose the following best practices for PIs.

Engagement:

- You and your team will adhere to policies developed by the BBQS Consortium to the best of your ability
- You and your team will adhere to standards and best practices adopted by the BBQS Consortium to the best of your ability
- Make a good faith effort to have a representative from your award attend the PI meetings (with voting rights)
- Make a good faith effort to commit to having at least one representative from your award attend the SC meetings (with voting rights)
- Make a good faith effort to commit to having at least one team member participate in WGs and TFs
- Make a good faith effort to:
 - Respond to requests for information, agreement, and reporting
 - Attend the annual in-person BBQS consortium meeting
 - Attend virtual meetings
 - Work collaboratively on issues
 - [Share data on Ember ASAP \(it does not need to be made publicly available immediately, but it may be shared within the Consortium to further internal projects such as tool building, cross-project analytics, and other shared deliverables\)](#)
- You or your team will present your work to the BBQS Consortium a minimum of once a year in the BBQS Forum or similar venue

Defining BBQS Participation

For the purpose of PI participation & SC participation, this section will define what is considered a BBQS project:

- BBQS Grant or Cooperative Agreement awardees
- Contributors of data to BBQS program
- Contributors of tools, models, infrastructure, frameworks (e.g., ethical), etc. to BBQS program

BBQS Policies:

BBQS policies will be referenced here.

As of July 16, 2026, the following are **proposed** BBQS Policies (voting by PIs yet to be done), none of these have been adopted at this time.

- [Conflict Resolution](#)
 - [Data Sharing Policy](#)
 - [Internal Data Sharing Policy](#)
 - Publication Policy
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CONFLICT RESOLUTION

All BBQS Consortium members are encouraged to engage in a respectful and equitable way and to resolve disagreements in a manner that strengthens the collaboration and advances the scientific and community goals of BBQS.

Should conflicts arise within a committee, the committee chair or vice chair should act as mediator. If the conflict remains unresolved, an ad hoc Dispute Resolution Panel (DRP) shall be formed comprising a representative from NIH (not directly involved in the project awards of those involved in the conflict), the PI, SC, and DCAIC. Additional expertise may be added as necessary.

Process:

- The parties in conflict will each submit their ideal solution and a compromise solution privately to the DRP.
 - The DRP will review these suggestions and propose a solution
 - The DRP will then hold a conference call with the parties in conflict to discuss this solution
 - After the call, the DRP will recommend a final decision to the NIH program official who will make the final decision.
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PROPOSAL FOR FUTURE COMMITTEE:

THIS COMMITTEE WILL BE RE-EVALUATED WHEN THE NEED ARISES.
ACCEPTANCE OF THIS DOCUMENT DOES NOT INCLUDE ACCEPTANCE OF THIS
COMMITTEE AT THIS TIME.

Data Access Committee (DAC)

The Data Access Committee (DAC) is a special Working Group. It will serve as a trusted advisory body and facilitative body that reviews and makes decisions on access requests.

Composition:

- DAC should consist of 7 to 9 members, each covering multiple relevant areas of expertise, including data management, ethics, relevant research areas and potentially a data sharing advocate.
- DAC will include representation from both NIH and DCAIC/EMBER.
- The ELSI group will recommend a slate of representatives to the PI Committee for approval. ELSI will accept nominations from the Consortium for members of this committee.
- Committee members would be expected to serve a two year term. Membership will be reviewed after two years with an option for renewal for another two year term.

Responsibilities:

- Review requests for controlled-access data, primarily to confirm that the proposed research is consistent with the data use limitations established by the submitting institution through the Attestation document and related governance materials.
- Coordinate communication between requesters and data-submitting investigators when clarification or collaboration is appropriate.
- Approve or reject requests for BBQS restricted or controlled-access data.

Meeting Schedule:

- *Ad hoc* meetings as needed for urgent matters
 - Other updates may take place over email
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